

1960–1969

EVENING SELECTION

In contrast to the rigid social constructs of 1950s evening attire, the 1960s offered a variety of elegant choices for going out. Gowns could be long or short, even mini for the young and hip. They could be highly trimmed and decorated, or plain – solid or print. Trousers were worn as formal eveningwear by the daring. For gowns, A-line silhouettes, empire waists, and undefined bodices were popular, though some soft shaping was also in use. Materials for elaborate surface decoration ranged from feathers and jewels to beads and faux fur. Many designers created evening clothes in bright colours or black and white patterns. Popular designers of the decade included French designers Hubert de Givenchy and Yves Saint Laurent, as well as the youthful British designer Jean Muir of Jane and Jane, and Italian designers Emilio Pucci and Valentino.



Trouser dress The end of the 1960s saw an increasing interest in trousers. This 1968 evening trouser dress by Italian designer Emilio Pucci, in one of his signature bold patterns, references maxi dresses – also popular at the time.

Coq skirt This 1968 cocktail dress by French designer Givenchy has focused volume on the skirt, created by layers of dyed-black coq feathers. This gives a unique texture and shape to the otherwise monochromatic design.

Feathered trim This salmon-coloured silk evening gown from Givenchy's Fall/Winter 1968–69 collection is trimmed along each hem with feathers. They give the dress an added sense of movement and flow, and also a touch of drama.